

BRAND STRATEGY & MESSAGING

Brand Strategy

An effective brand strategy is more than an attractive logo; it's messaging that resonates with your target audience. A good one can lead to enhanced perceived value, customer loyalty, and competitive advantage. It's your first impression; it must stand out to your customer. Your brand speaks to the mission, values, visual identity, and personality of your company. It can communicate with audiences without you even having to say anything.

So, what makes up a brand? Pieces like mission, vision, positioning, values, brand personality, voice/tone, identity, and visual elements all make up brand strategy. These serve as a framework for all business activities, promoting consistency throughout all departments and marketing efforts of the company. These pieces come together to share a message encompassing all that the company is and stands for.

Brand Messaging: the Purpose and Promise of the Company

Brand messaging is the intersection of the company's purpose and the effect of that purpose on your audience. This involves a promise, a value or experience a customer can expect at every interaction with the company. Brand messaging communicates your purpose to who you intend to impact. Brand strategy begins with identifying the individual brand pieces that will guide your overall approach.

Essential Elements of a Brand

Clear brand messaging begins with clearly defining the mission and vision of the brand. This establishes the company's purpose and long-term goals. The vision is the reason the brand exists, defining what it aspires to be. The mission is comprised of who you serve and how you reach these goals. It describes the direction by which the vision is reached.

Identify brand values to determine positioning. Values are the core principles driving the brand positioning, what differentiates your brand from competitors. Write a positioning statement to clearly define what sets your brand apart from competitors in the mind of the constituents.

Develop brand personality by describing the traits, human characteristics of the brand, that build and enhance the relationship between your brand and its prospects. These traits are expressed through brand voice and tone, which is the language and communication style of the brand.

Building the Brand through Design and Advertising

This understanding of the core components of the brand drive the strategy behind the creative elements, including the visual elements and tagline. The tagline is a short, memorable, and customer-facing phrase that conveys the value of the brand and its benefit. It is generally used in conjunction with the brand's logo.

Logos are a foundational element of the brand. Professionals in graphic design bring to life the core components of the brand into a visual representation. A well-designed logo provides brand recognition and fosters customer loyalty. Brand guidelines describe all logo variations, color palettes, wording and aesthetics of the brand, to provide consistency across all marketing and business materials.

Finally, communicate the brand both internally and externally through authentic messages and creative storytelling. This is the narrative that will connect the brand and its values to the audience. Brand strategy informs advertising, a powerful tool to establish and maintain relationships within the company and with your target audience.

Elevate your business by partnering with an agency to develop and communicate a powerful brand strategy. Professionals in advertising and design provide expertise in design, storytelling, and brand positioning. Investing in an agency ensures conveying a cohesive message that truly resonates with your audience.

The result? Better businesses.

